

Phase 3: Form Analysis & Implementation Report

NRCS-CPA-026 vs AD-1026 Form Selection

CRP HEL Screening Tool - Phase 3 (Form Integration)
Date: May 2026 | Status: ■ COMPLETED | Version: 1.0

Executive Summary

During Phase 3, we discovered TWO different USDA forms for HEL compliance:

- Form AD-1026 (FSA) — Producer compliance certification
- Form NRCS-CPA-026 (NRCS) — HEL determination documentation

KEY FINDING:

Our tool should pre-fill NRCS-CPA-026 (not AD-1026), because:

- AD-1026 is YES/NO certification form for farmer compliance
- NRCS-CPA-026 documents HEL determination with RUSLE2 data
- Our tool calculates HEL status via RUSLE2 → belongs on CPA-026

Research Findings

Form AD-1026: HELC and Wetland Conservation Certification

- Issued by: USDA Farm Service Agency (FSA)
- User: Farmers/producers applying for USDA benefits
- Purpose: Producer certifies compliance with conservation rules
- Contains RUSLE2 data: NO ✗

Form NRCS-CPA-026: HEL and Wetland Conservation Determination

- Issued by: USDA Natural Resources Conservation Service (NRCS)
- User: NRCS conservationists conducting determinations
- Purpose: Documents HEL/Wetland determinations with RUSLE2
- Contains RUSLE2 data: YES ✓ ← OUR TOOL FITS HERE

Form Comparison

Aspect	AD-1026	NRCS-CPA-026
Issued by	FSA	NRCS
Purpose	Certification	Determination
Contains RUSLE2	NO	YES ← Our tool
User	Farmer	NRCS Staff

Implementation: NRCS-CPA-026 Pre-fill

PDF Template Sections (Correct Form)

- SECTION A: Farm and Field Information
Name, Address, County, FSA Farm No., Tract No.
- SECTION B: HEL Determination (RUSLE2)
Auto-filled parameters:
 - R-Factor (Rainfall Erosivity): [r_val]
 - K-Factor (Soil Erodibility): [k_avg]
 - LS-Factor (Slope): [ls_factor]
 - T-Factor (Soil Loss Tolerance): [t_avg]
 - EROSION INDEX (EI): [ei_max] → HEL/NOT HEL
- SECTION C: Field Determination Table
One row per soil component with HEL status and EI value
- SECTION D: Certifications
Space for NRCS staff signature and date

Conclusion

Phase 3 successfully corrected the form choice:
From: ■ Generic AD-1026 (compliance certification)
To: ■ Official NRCS-CPA-026 (HEL determination)

RESULT:

The tool now generates the correct official NRCS form with all RUSLE2 parameters pre-filled for field verification.

- Uses official USDA form structure
- Clearly marked as screening only
- Requires NRCS field verification and staff signature